Negotiation Simulation

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Context

A construction company is looking to purchase a beachfront land in Monaco to develop a 12-floor, 5-star hotel.

The land they acquired is located in front of a villa community. However, the residents strongly oppose any new construction, as they are emotionally attached to the view and local frog population.

Environmental activists have been protesting for the past seven days, demanding that the land be turned into a eco-park instead. The city, however, is open to the idea of a hotel classified as a 5-star establishment that meets Monaco's high standards. The urban development will also be positively impacted.

The mayor was expected to make a final decision two days ago, but the situation remains unresolved. If this continues, the investor may pull out of the project. Time is running out.

Roles

- Inhabitants representative

One of the habitants of the villa is representing the community.

▼ Hotel construction company

This is the 3rd Hotel they want to build. They already found success in Mallorca and Milano.

▼ Mayor ***Georges Marsan***

Mayor of Monaco since 2003.

▼ Ecology activist

This same group of activist managed to cancel the construction of an aquarium a few years ago.

Learning Effects

1. **Seperate the problem from the people**: emotional tensions (the residents' attachement to the frog population) can be distracting from the actual problem
2. **Understanding each others true interests**: positions could be "No hotel should be built" or "We must build the hotel", but underlying interests like "we want a profitable high-end project" must be found first
3. **The result doesn't have to be binary**: the story leaves room for creative compromises or even win-win situations like:
    - The hotel incorporates an eco-park
    - The residents get partial ownership or input in green space management
    - Instead of viewing the hotel as a threat, residents could benefit from added property value or job opportunities in an eco-friendly, luxury establishment
    - The activists manage to convince the mayor and the residents that the projects can have bad environmental incomes
4. **Using objective criteria**: referring to environmental standards or other legal regulations
    - Monaco's construction and environmental laws
    - "Green Building" certification

Point system

We are using a point system to make the game easy understandable. Each participant will be given tables to negotiate with. This tables are representing different categories like hotel size, environmental impact and financial decision.

Different solutions are allowed : for example the hotel will be built with a small park to protect the ecosystem in place. Additionally small amount of taxes will be given to the city and a compensation given to the neighbours.